

HARRISON MITCHELL

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EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego

2021–2027 (expected)

Ph.D. in Economics

Advisors: Nir Jaimovich & Samuel Bazzi

Macalester College

2015–2019

B.A. in Economics, with honors

Minor in English Literature

RESEARCH FIELDS

Macroeconomics, Development Economics, Spatial Economics

REFERENCES

Nir Jaimovich, Professor

Department of Economics, UCSD

nijaimovich@ucsd.edu

Juan Herreño, Assistant Professor

Department of Economics, UCSD

jherrenolopera@ucsd.edu

Samuel Bazzi, Professor

Department of Economics, UCSD

sbazzi@ucsd.edu

Gaurav Khanna, Associate Professor

School of Global Policy and Strategy, UCSD

gakhanna@ucsd.edu

JOB MARKET PAPER

The Curse of Connectivity: Evidence from Village Resettlement in Indonesia

Does connecting a village to markets make it richer? Using Indonesia's Transmigration program, which created new villages with variation in initial connectivity, I find that otherwise similar villages that began more connected are poorer today. A one standard deviation increase in initial market access lowers GDP per capita decades later by roughly 4 percent. Higher connectivity shifts village residents out of agriculture and into local non-farm work. I argue that this reallocation lowers income because of a scale externality in agriculture. To inspect the mechanism, I use separate variation in villages' initial settlement sizes and estimate a positive agricultural scale externality. A spatial general equilibrium model of Indonesia reproduces the negative effect of market access when the scale externality is present. In counterfactuals, ignoring the externality overstates aggregate gains from road-network improvements by 18 percent and from increases in rural agricultural productivity by 64 percent. An agricultural earnings subsidy at the road program's fiscal outlay delivers roughly twice its rural gains.

PUBLICATIONS

Herder-Related Violence, Labor Allocation, and the Gendered Response of Agricultural Households

with Jeffrey Bloem, Amy Damon, and David Francis

Journal of Development Economics, Volume 176, 2025

Migration and the Labor Market Impacts of COVID-19

with Nathan Barker, C. Austin Davis, Paula López-Peña, Mushfiq Mobarak, Karim Naguib, Maira Reimão, Ashish Shenoy, and Corey Vernot

European Economic Review, Volume 158, 2023

WORKING PAPERS

Delegation Risk and Implementation at Scale: Evidence from a Migration Loan Program in Bangladesh

with Mushfiq Mobarak, Karim Naguib, Maira Reimão, and Ashish Shenoy

Revise and Resubmit, *Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics*

The Global Value of Cities

with Aakash Bhalothia, Gavin Engelstad, and Gaurav Khanna

WORK IN PROGRESS

The Evolution of Inequality

Land Inequality and Rural Structural Transformation: Evidence from India

with Manaswini Rao and Frances Lu

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS, AND GRANTS

PhD Research Grant (STEG-CEPR) (£15,000)	2023
PhD Research Grant (STEG-CEPR) (£15,000)	2022
Summer Graduate Research Fellowship, Economics Department, UCSD	2022–2023
Regents Fellowship, UCSD	2021–2022

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Yale University – Research Assistant for Mushfiq Mobarak	2019–2021
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TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of California, San Diego – Teaching Assistant ECON 1, ECON 3, ECON 4, ECON 100B, ECON 110A, ECON 129, GPCO 403, GPEC 450	2021–Present
Macalester College – Teaching Assistant Intermediate Macroeconomics (ECON 371)	2017–2019

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2026 STEG Annual Conference; Urbanization and Development Annual Conference; Firms, Trade, and Development; Urban Economics Association North America Meeting*

2025 STEG Annual Conference, UCSD

2024 Southern California Applied Economics Conference, UCSD

* *scheduled*

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee: *Journal of Development Economics, Food Policy*

COMPUTER SKILLS

Stata, MATLAB, Python, R, QGIS

LANGUAGES

English (native), Spanish (intermediate)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship: USA